PEER REVIEW HISTORY

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ARTICLE DETAILS

TITLE (PROVISIONAL)	A systematic review protocol of educational and training interventions aimed at healthcare workers in the detection and management of people with mental health conditions in South and South-East Asia
AUTHORS	Koly, Kamrun Nahar; Baskin, Cleo; Lata, Ivy; Rao, Mala; Rasheed, Sabrina; Law, Graham; Gnani, Shamini

VERSION 1 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Cheng, Wan-Ju China Medical University
REVIEW RETURNED	26-Jan-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	This systemic review protocol aimed to conduct literature review concerning healthcare workforce training for mental disorders detection and management in South and Southeast Asian countries. The topic is important and has health policies implications. I have minor comments which I hope will improve the protocol. 1. Introduction of abstract:"… Capacity building of mental health professionals is essential to support programmes related to the detection and management of patients with mental health conditions. …" This sentence can be misleading that the study population is mental health professionals, such as psychiatrist, psychologists, or nursing specialists. Please consider revising. 2. Similarly, in page 6 line 3-5: "activity associated with education, training or capacity building that aims to improve the ability of health care professionals to detect and manage mental health disorders…" According to the method section, the type of participants include lay workers and therefore are not restricted to health care professionals. The authors used "healthcare workforce" in earlier texts and is suitable here. 3. Page 6 line 15-17, type of outcome measures are described as changes in all mental health conditions. Did the authors mean prevalence or detection rate or treatment rate of mental health conditions? Please clarify. Also in table 1, the outcome (mental health conditions) was undefined.

REVIEWER	Zechner, Michelle Rutgers University

REVIEW RETURNED	26-Feb-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	P. 4 of document - line 37 - “Centralized distribution” is unclear, please clarify what this means. P. 5 - line 43- training alone is not sufficient in changing practices without continued oversight and evaluation. Consider adding in a sentence about skill development and practices that support skill development. P. 5 - line 49- please clarify why volunteers, students etc. will be excluded. P. 6 - line 17 - when you say “changes in all mental health conditions” do you mean improvements in mental health conditions?

VERSION 1 – AUTHOR RESPONSE

Sl. No.	Reviewer’s comment	Response
Reviewer 1 (Dr. Wan-Ju Cheng, China Medical University)		
1	**Introduction of abstract: Capacity building of mental health professionals is essential to support programmes related to the detection and management of patients with mental health conditions. …”** **This sentence can be misleading that the study population is mental health professionals, such as psychiatrist, psychologists, or nursing specialists. Please consider revising.**	Thank you for your comment. We have revised this sentence in the manuscript (page 2, line 2) to read. *“Capacity building of healthcare workers is essential to support programmes related to the detection and management of patients with mental health conditions”*
2	**Similarly, in page 6 line 3-5: activity associated with education, training or capacity building that aims to improve the ability of health care professionals to detect and manage mental health**	Thank you, we have revised the sentence to read (page 6, line 1): *“Interventions of interest include any activity associated with education,*

	disorders…" **According to the method section, the type of participants includes lay workers and therefore are not restricted to health care professionals. The authors used "healthcare workforce" in earlier texts and is suitable here.**	*training or capacity building that aims to improve the ability of healthcare workers to detect and manage mental health disorders"*
3	**Page 6 line 15-17, type of outcome measures is described as changes in all mental health conditions.** **Did the authors mean prevalence or detection rate or treatment rate of mental health conditions? Please clarify.** **Also, in table 1, the outcome (mental health conditions) was undefined.**	Thank you for your comment. We have re-phrased this to be: *"As outcome, we will include studies that report improvements in detection and management of mental health conditions by healthcare workers, and their knowledge, skills and attitudes of mental health conditions.* (page 6, line 6). We have also revised Table 1 to reflect the outcome measures. (page 8)

Reviewer 2 (Dr. Michelle Zechner, Rutgers University)

4	**P. 4 of document - line 37 - "Centralized distribution" is unclear, please clarify what this means.**	Thank you for your comment. We have revised this sentence in the manuscript and hope that this is clearer. The sentence now reads: *"In addition, the mental health workforce is mainly concentrated in urban areas, where there are few primary healthcare workers trained in mental health care.* *Inadequate mental health training among primary healthcare workers and inadequate staffing of mental health specialists, together with a lack of appropriate skill mix, affects the overall care pathways in terms of diagnosis, treatment and prevention of mental health illness"* (Page 4, line 18).
5	**P. 5 - line 43- training alone is not sufficient in changing practices without continued oversight and evaluation. Consider adding in a sentence about skill development and practices that support skill development.**	Thank you for your insightful comment, we agree entirely and have included a sentence on page 5 line 4. The sentence reads now: *"In order to make sustainable and effective changes to practice among trained healthcare workers, ongoing learning and skill development needs to be integral to the capacity building*

		intervention (Karim MR et al., 2012)
6	**P. 5 - line 49- please clarify why volunteers, students etc. will be excluded.**	Thank you for your comment. We have revised the sentence and clarified our reasons behind this exclusion (page 5, line 23). This now reads: *"Volunteers or medical or nursing students will be excluded as study participants because they do not reflect the formal healthcare system and are not directly involved in the provision of clinical care"*

7	**P. 6 - line 17 - when you say "changes in all mental health conditions" do you mean improvements in mental health conditions?**	Thank you for your comment. We have re-phrased this to be: *"Improvement in detection and management of mental health conditions and improvement of knowledge, skills and attitudes of healthcare workers"* (page 6, line 6).